Day 19 · Week 4 · Decide, deliver, defend

Measurement and the pitch

How will we know whether the recommendation is working, and can we make the case in five slides?



Day 19 of 20 · Gate 4 submission today

Today

By the end of today, you will have

Built an indicator framework, drafted your deck, rehearsed the five-slide pitch and submitted Gate 4.

- Separate input, output and outcome indicators.
- Give each indicator a source, a baseline requirement and a frequency, and disaggregate at least one.
- Link the riskiest assumptions to early indicators and review points.
- Build and rehearse a five-slide pitch with the recommendation in the first minute.

Competencies: H5 · I2 · I4

Session plan

10 min	**Opening problem**
20 min	**Concept: indicators**
15 min	**Demonstration: Madhyapur indicators**
35 min	**Thursday challenge: five-slide challenge**
30 min	**Gate 4: rehearsal and peer review**
10 min	**Debrief and exit task**

Opening problem

- **Your programme reports that 40,000 households received two bins. Is it working?**

What would you need to see before saying yes?

From money to outcomes: what each indicator tells you

1	2	3	4	5
Inputs	**Activities**	**Outputs**	**Outcomes**	**Impact**
Money spent, staff hired. Tells you effort.	Trainings held, contracts signed. Tells you work done.	Bins delivered, wards covered. Tells you services provided.	Households separating, waste diverted. Tells you change.	Landfill life extended, safer work. Tells you what mattered.

Programmes are often judged on outputs because outputs are easy to count. Insist on at least one outcome indicator.

An indicator tree for Madhyapur, option B



Each leaf needs a source, a baseline and a frequency. The informal settlement indicator guards against the averages problem from Day 12.

Indicator framework: Madhyapur (extract)

Indicator	Type	Source	Baseline	Frequency
Households separating, by ward type	Outcome	Monthly inspection sample	Set in pilot month 1	Monthly
Dry waste collected by the cooperative	Output	Cooperative weighbridge records	Zero	Monthly
Dry waste reaching landfill	Outcome	Landfill gate records	City records (illustrative)	Quarterly
Pickers with contracts	Output	Cooperative register	Set at start	Quarterly

SMART: specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, time-bound. Set targets only where a baseline exists.

Early warning: link the riskiest assumptions to indicators

Assumption at risk	Early indicator	Review point
Households respond to seeing separation respected	Separation in pilot wards after three months	First quarterly review
The cooperative can scale	Wards covered against plan	Monthly
Crews do not divert recyclables	Dry waste tonnage against estimates	Monthly

Adaptive management: each review point is a decision to continue, adjust or stop.

A thinker for your case

John Kingdon

Agendas, Alternatives, and Public Policies, 1984

Kingdon argued that policy change happens when three streams meet: a recognised problem, an available policy and favourable politics. When they align, a window opens, briefly.

The question it puts to your case

Is there a window for this recommendation, and which stream is missing?

Answer it in one sentence in your workbook today.

The five-slide pitch

Slide	Content	Time
1	The recommendation and the decision required	1 minute
2	The diagnosis: why the problem persists	1 minute
3	The evidence, and how confident you are	1.5 minutes
4	The choice: options, criteria, and why this one	1.5 minutes
5	Delivery: plan, risks, indicators and the next step	1 minute

Six minutes in all. The full deck of 10 to 12 slides is submitted separately; its slides are your back-up in the defence.

Activity: The five-slide challenge

Compress a complex analysis into a five-slide story with the recommendation first.

Scenario

Each pod takes the evidence dossier from Day 15 (take-up of a maternity benefit scheme) and builds five slides for the district collector, following the five-slide structure. Pods then present in four minutes, not six, to raise the pressure.

What to do

1. Agree the recommendation and the decision required, in one sentence.
2. Assign one slide to each member; the chair takes slide one.
3. Write argument titles: each title states the slide's claim.
4. Present in four minutes; another pod times and questions you.
5. Revise your weakest slide title.

Time 35 minutes (Thursday challenge)

Groups Pods of four

Output Five slides with argument titles

Gate 4: rehearsal and peer review (30 minutes)

1

Pair

Pair with someone outside your pod.

2

Pitch

Deliver your five slides in six minutes; your partner times you.

3

Question

Your partner asks two red team questions.

4

Feedback

One strength, one critical weakness, one required revision.

5

Submit

Submit the draft deck and indicator framework tonight.

Pairing outside the pod gives each analyst a reader who does not know the case, like the panel tomorrow.

Your case: Worksheet 9.1

Indicator framework and draft deck

1. Build an indicator tree from your final outcome down to measurable leaves.
2. For each indicator give type, source, baseline requirement and frequency; disaggregate at least one.
3. Link your riskiest assumptions to early indicators and review points.
4. Draft your full deck (10 to 12 slides) and your five-slide pitch.
5. Submit Gate 4 with a revision note and AI disclosure.

Hand in

Gate 4 (Worksheets 7.1, 7.2, 8.1 and 9.1, revised, with the draft deck) by the end of Day 19. Brief written feedback is returned before Day 20.

Quality check

At least one outcome indicator.

Tag every claim in your Analyst's Ledger: fact, inference, assumption or hypothesis.

What to take away

1. Count outcomes, not just outputs.
2. Give every indicator a source, a baseline and a frequency; disaggregate where averages hide.
3. Link the riskiest assumptions to early indicators and review points.
4. Recommendation first: five argument titles should tell the whole story.

Exit task Read your five slide titles to a neighbour. Ask them to tell your recommendation back to you.

Before the next session

Independent work

Rehearse your pitch twice, timed. Prepare answers to the five red team questions for your own case. About 60 minutes.

Read

Kingdon, Agendas, Alternatives, and Public Policies, the chapter on the policy window.

Next

Day 20: The defence

Tomorrow: the panel. Present, defend, and learn what your analysis can withstand.